Tactix Documentation Compaction

Tactix Development Project

August 8, 2026

Executive summary

The three largest rule-development documents were compacted without changing the solver calculus or dropping an active requirement. Historical narration now lives in Git and frozen evidence, while the living documents retain the formal rules, implementation invariants, current deviations, and reusable experimental lessons. Automated size limits were tightened to prevent silent regrowth.

1 Findings and results

- `docs/calculus.md` now uses a short statement of authority and abstract state while retaining every rule's precondition, effect, proof delta, and soundness argument. It is 544 lines, down from 581.
- `docs/implementation-notes.md` is 718 lines, down from 1,253. Closed experiment chronology was replaced by current invariants, exact defaults, ownership boundaries, and reopening triggers. The active scheduling-parity ledger and rule-inventory table remain intact.
- `docs/lessons.md` is 63 lines, down from 121 and from roughly 25 KiB to 6 KiB. Retractions and obsolete magnitudes were removed; the current methodological conclusions remain self-contained.
- `tools/docs/check-doc-size.py` now caps these files at 600, 800, and 100 lines respectively, leaving modest editing headroom.

2 Evidence

The document-size, reference-option coverage, and rule-inventory checks all pass. The option audit accounts for all 418 pinned reference options, and the inventory accounts for all 28 rule families. The release test suite passed 57 of 58 tests. The sole failure, `comment_hygiene`, reports two first-person comments in pre-existing source edits outside this documentation change; those user changes were deliberately not modified.

Primary sources are `docs/calculus.md`, `docs/implementation-notes.md`, `docs/lessons.md`, and `tools/docs/check-doc-size.py`. Historical detail remains recoverable from the repository history and the frozen material under `benchmarks/reports/`, `docs/design/`, and `docs/log/`.

3 Risks and decisions

The calculus was compacted conservatively because its detailed soundness arguments are implementation requirements, not disposable narrative. The implementation notes received a second semantic audit after the initial edit; exact configuration defaults, proof-ID rules, retry-mark sources, scope ranges, and watch invariants were restored wherever a shorter summary would have required a future agent to consult history. No benchmark or solver-behavior claim was changed.

4 Next actions

Future edits should keep one fact in one living-document home and point to frozen evidence rather than copying experiment narratives. Any addition that exceeds the new size budgets should first remove superseded material or justify a deliberate budget revision. The unrelated source-comment hygiene failure can be resolved by the owner of the current kernel/policy work before that source increment lands.